GOLD STANDARD · VERBATIM DIET POSTER

NO REGULATORY BANNER — EXEMPT REPTILE
Outside USDA / TPWD jurisdiction. Husbandry per LIFE protocol.

SULCATA TORTOISE

Centrochelys sulcata

GRAZING TORTOISE — HAY ONLY

WHAT THIS ANIMAL IS: Grass-grazing tortoise — Sub-Saharan Africa
SITES: Houston · SAA · Other

3-SEC CHECK: Do I see only hay?

STANDARD DIET — HEALTHY ANIMALS ONLY

Excludes sick / vet-care / special-diet animals

Covers ~95% of daily feedings. For the remaining 5%, use training and observation within sound science. Unsure — Pause. Ask. Escalate.

MORNING FEED-OUT

Grass hay only — whole, not chopped. Fresh water always. No greens, no veg, no fruit.

APPROX DAILY: Per posted portion chart

ENCOUNTER / ENRICHMENT PORTION

Pulled fistful of hay for hand-feeding. Drawn from daily allocation, not extra.

CORRECT — Grass hay only

Grass hay

Timothy hay

WRONG — FIX IMMEDIATELY — Fruit · Vegetables · Greens · Pellets

Apple

Carrot

Kale

Romaine

SIMPLE BUILD

- Grass hay only

PREP RULE

Hay only. Never fruit. Never vegetables. Never greens.

MATCH THE BOWL — DO NOT INTERPRET.

No photo = feeding not complete. · No substitutions without approval. · Unsure → Pause → Ask → Escalate.

POST AT EXHIBIT · DO NOT REMOVE · SUPERSEDES PRIOR DIET CARDS

Source: DIETS-steward-export PART 4 §24 · Owner directive: 'Tortoises eat HAY ONLY' · Verbatim Gold Standard
LIFE Diet Governance System · Gold Standard v2026.04.25 · Match the bowl. Don't interpret.